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MARC Insights

Indian Packaging Manufacturing Industry

JULY 2026



Glossary

Abbreviation	Full Form
BOPP	Biaxially Oriented Polypropylene
CAGR	Compound Annual Growth Rate
CPCB	Central Pollution Control Board
EPR	Extended Producer Responsibility
ESG	Environmental, Social and Governance
EBITDA	Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation and Amortization
FMCG	Fast-Moving Consumer Goods
HDPE	High-Density Polyethylene
IBC	Intermediate Bulk Container
MSME	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
NFC	Near Field Communication
PE	Polyethylene
PET	Polyethylene Terephthalate
PLI	Production Linked Incentive
PP	Polypropylene
PVC	Polyvinyl Chloride

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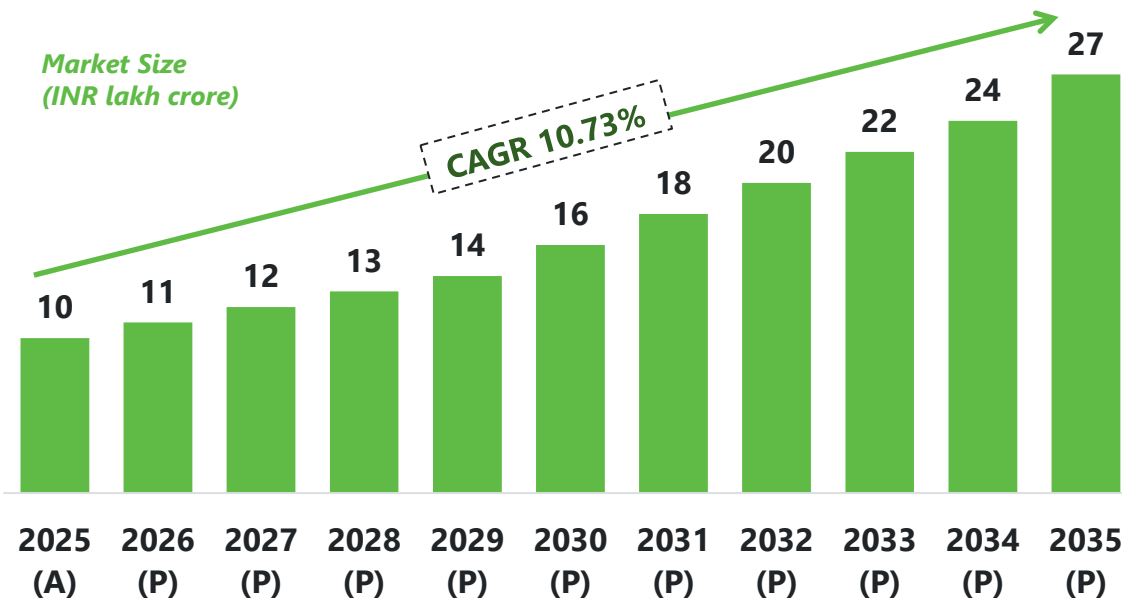
Our perspective on the strategic initiatives that will shape the next phase of growth in India's packaging industry.

Indian Packaging Industry Overview

Understanding the market landscape, growth drivers, and packaging ecosystem driving India's manufacturing sector.

Overview of the Indian Packaging Industry

Indian Packaging Market Size (2025–2035)



- The Indian packaging industry is projected to witness sustained double-digit growth, expanding from approximately **INR 10 lakh crore** in 2025 to **INR 27 lakh crore** by 2035.
- Rising manufacturing output, export demand, increasing consumption, and investments in sustainable and technology-enabled packaging are expected to drive long-term market expansion.

Source: [marketresearchfuture](#), [mordorintelligence](#)

What is the Packaging Industry?

The packaging industry develops solutions that protect, preserve, transport, and promote products. It includes flexible packaging, rigid plastics, paper & paperboard, glass, metal, and sustainable materials, serving industries such as FMCG, pharmaceuticals, food & beverages, electronics, and e-commerce.

Industries Driving Packaging Demand in India



FMCG



Pharmaceuticals



Food & Beverages



E-Commerce & Logistics



Personal Care & Cosmetics



Electronics

Flexible & Rigid Packaging in India (1/2)

What is Flexible Packaging?

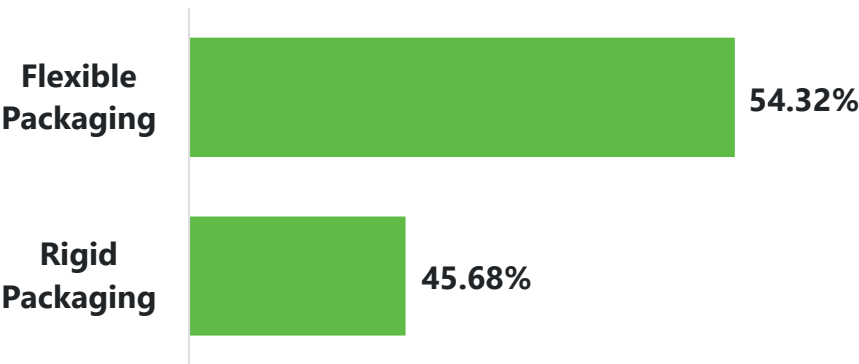
- Flexible packaging uses materials such as plastic films, paper, aluminum foil, and laminates that can bend or change shape.
- It is widely used across the food, pharmaceutical, personal care, and e-commerce industries due to its lightweight design, cost efficiency, and superior product protection.
- UFlex, Jindal Poly Films, Polyplex Corporation, Cosmo First, and EPL are among India's leading flexible packaging manufacturers

What is Rigid Packaging?

- Rigid packaging refers to packaging made from materials that retain their shape and provide high structural strength.
- Common materials include plastic, glass, metal, and paperboard, making it suitable for products requiring durability, product protection, and extended shelf life.
- AGI Greenpac, Time Technoplast, Mold-Tek Packaging, Hindustan National Glass & Industries (HNGIL), and TCPL Packaging are among the leading Indian companies in the rigid packaging industry.

Source: [marketresearchfuture](#), [mordorintelligence](#)

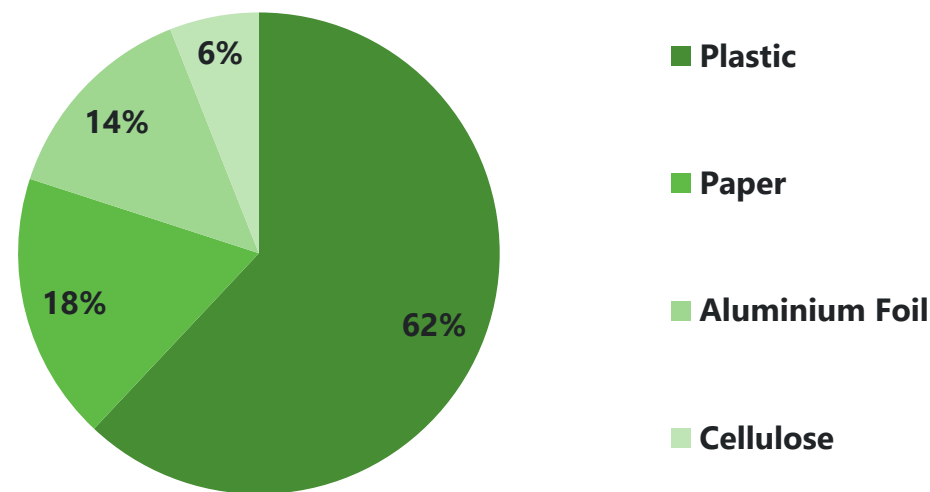
Market Composition by Packaging Type



- **Flexible packaging** accounts for **54.32% of India's packaging market**, driven by its lightweight design, cost efficiency, and widespread adoption across FMCG, food & beverages, pharmaceuticals, and e-commerce.
- **Rigid packaging** represents the remaining **45.68%**, supported by strong demand for applications requiring superior durability, structural integrity, and extended product protection.

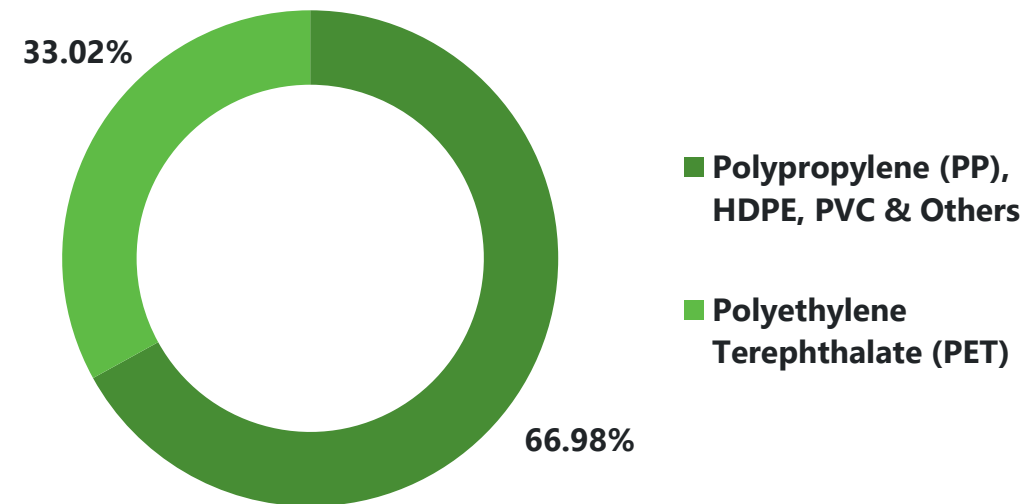
Flexible & Rigid Packaging in India (2/2)

India Flexible Packaging Market Share by Raw Material (2025)



- **Plastic dominates India's flexible packaging market with a 62% share**, driven by its lightweight design, cost efficiency, durability, and superior barrier properties across food, beverage, pharmaceutical, and personal care applications.
- **Paper, aluminum foil, and cellulose collectively account for 38% of the market**, reflecting the growing adoption of sustainable, high-barrier, and specialty packaging materials across key industries.

India Rigid Plastic Packaging Market by Resin Type (2025)



- **PP, HDPE, PVC, and other resins collectively represented 66.98% of the market**, serving applications such as food containers, personal care products, industrial packaging, and household goods.
- **PET accounted for 33.02% of India's rigid plastic packaging market in 2025**, driven by strong demand from the food & beverage and pharmaceutical industries.

Source: [marketresearchfuture](#), [mordorintelligence](#)

Key Growth Drivers of the Indian Packaging Industry

Rising FMCG Consumption

Growing disposable incomes, urbanization, and changing consumer lifestyles are increasing demand for packaged food, beverages, personal care, and household products.

Expansion of E-Commerce

Rapid growth in online retail has increased demand for corrugated boxes, flexible packaging, protective materials, and efficient last-mile delivery solutions.

Growth in Pharmaceuticals & Healthcare

Expanding pharmaceutical production and healthcare demand are driving the need for sterile, tamper-evident, and regulatory-compliant packaging solutions.

Food Processing Industry

Urbanization and changing dietary habits are increasing demand for packaged, ready-to-eat, and processed foods, boosting the need for hygienic packaging.

Sustainability & Regulatory Push

Environmental regulations and consumer awareness are accelerating the adoption of recyclable, biodegradable, lightweight, and paper-based packaging materials.

Government Support & Manufacturing Growth

Government initiatives, infrastructure development, and manufacturing investments are strengthening India's packaging ecosystem and supporting long-term industry growth.

Source: [marketresearchfuture](#), [mordorintelligence](#)

Packaging Materials Used in India

Criteria	Plastic	Paper & Paperboard	Glass	Metal	Bio-based Materials
 Material Profile	Lightweight, durable, moisture-resistant	Renewable, lightweight, recyclable	Inert, impermeable, premium	Strong, rigid, high-barrier	Compostable, biodegradable
 Core Uses	Bottles, films, pouches, containers	Cartons, corrugated boxes, paper bags	Bottles, jars, vials	Cans, aerosols, drums	Food packaging, takeaway containers, shopping bags
 Key Benefits	Cost-efficient, versatile	Sustainable, printable	Product protection, reusable	Long shelf life, durable	Eco-friendly, renewable
 End-Use Industries	FMCG, Pharma, Personal Care	Retail, E-commerce, FMCG	Beverages, Pharma, Cosmetics	Food, Beverage, Industrial	Food Service, Retail
 Leading Companies	UFlex, Time Technoplast	TCPL Packaging, JK Paper	AGI Greenpac, HNGIL	Hindustan Tin Works	Pakka Ltd., Bio Reform
 Future Outlook	Recycled plastics & mono-materials	Fastest-growing sustainable material	Premium packaging demand	Growth in food & beverage	Rapid adoption with policy support

Source: [marketresearchfuture](#), [mordorintelligence](#)

Industry Transformation & Packaging Gaps

Analyzing the trends, innovations, policy support, and structural gaps shaping the future competitiveness of India's packaging industry.

Government Policies & Initiatives Supporting India's Packaging Industry

Plastic Waste Management & EPR Rules

- The Central Pollution Control Board enforces strict Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) mandates that legally bind brands, producers, and importers to collect and recycle their packaging waste.
- The policy bans non-compostable single-use plastics and forces companies to include minimum mandatory quotas of recycled plastic in new packaging.

National Packaging Initiative (2021)

- The Ministry of Commerce and Industry establishes standardized guidelines for eco-friendly packaging designs and funds central recycling infrastructure like Material Recovery Facilities.
- It also partners with the Indian Institute of Packaging to run certified training programs and provide funding to sustainable design startups.

Plastic Industry Subsidy for MSMEs

- The government offers small and medium businesses up to a 30% capital subsidy on machinery and a 5% interest subvention on term loans up to ₹5 crore to ease the financial burden of upgrading.
- It also provides up to 60% direct financial assistance to businesses transitioning away from traditional plastics to sustainable packaging lines.

Make in India & PLI Schemes

- The policy streamlines regulatory approvals and eases compliance to attract global investments and turn India into an export hub for advanced packaging machinery.
- It also uses Production Linked Incentives (PLI) to offer cash backs to domestic factories based on their sales growth, boosting large-scale manufacturing.

BioE3 Policy Implementation

- The Department of Biotechnology drives the development of high-performance bioplastics and agricultural-waste packaging papers to decrease industry reliance on petroleum and timber.
- This biological engineering framework creates green manufacturing jobs while keeping agricultural leftovers inside a circular economy.

Source: [ceew](#), [packaginginsights](#)

Technology & Innovation in India's Packaging Industry

Smart Packaging



Smart packaging incorporates **QR codes, RFID, NFC tags, and intelligent labels** to enable product authentication, real-time tracking, consumer engagement, and improved supply chain visibility.

Digital Printing



Digital printing enables **high-quality, customized packaging with shorter production runs**, allowing brands to respond quickly to changing market demands while reducing printing waste.

Automation & Robotics



Packaging manufacturers are increasingly deploying **robotic systems and automated production lines** to improve packaging speed, consistency, and operational efficiency.

AI & Data Analytics



Artificial intelligence and data analytics are being used for **quality inspection, demand forecasting, predictive maintenance, and inventory optimization**, improving manufacturing and supply chain performance.

Advanced Barrier Materials



Innovations in **high-barrier films, antimicrobial coatings, and active packaging materials** help improve product protection, extend shelf life, and maintain product quality.

3D Printing



3D printing supports **rapid prototyping and packaging design validation**, enabling faster product development, reduced design costs, and greater packaging customization.

Source: [imarcgroup](https://www.imarcgroup.com)

Key Industry Trends Shaping India's Packaging Industry



Sustainability & Circular Economy

- Packaging manufacturers are accelerating the adoption of **recyclable, mono-material, and compostable packaging** to comply with **Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR)** regulations and corporate ESG commitments.
- Investments in **PET bottle-to-bottle recycling** are also expanding to support circular packaging systems.



Flexible Packaging Leadership

- Flexible packaging remains the **largest packaging format**, driven by its lightweight design, cost efficiency, and versatility across FMCG, food & beverages, and personal care sectors.
- Manufacturers are increasingly investing in **mono-material flexible structures** to improve recyclability.



Quick Commerce & E-commerce Fulfilment

- The rapid expansion of **quick commerce and e-commerce** is increasing demand for **lightweight, right-sized, and tamper-evident packaging** that enhances product protection while improving logistics efficiency.
- Corrugated and secondary packaging continue to witness strong growth.



Pharmaceutical Packaging Expansion

- India's growing pharmaceutical manufacturing and exports are increasing demand for **high-performance primary packaging**, including **vials, ampoules, bottles, and pre-fillable syringes**.
- Regulatory compliance and product safety requirements continue to support market growth.

Source: [mordorintelligence](#), [Mordorintelligence](#), [Brickworkratings](#)

Global Benchmarks vs India's Packaging Reality



Sustainable Packaging Adoption

Global : Germany achieves 65%+ recycling through strict regulations.

India : High costs slow sustainable packaging adoption.



Export-Ready Packaging Standards

Global : Singapore and the Netherlands emphasize premium packaging, digital traceability, and standardized labelling.

India : Many MSMEs struggle to meet international standards.



Packaging Innovation & R&D

Global : The US, Japan, and South Korea invest heavily in smart packaging and advanced materials.

India : R&D remains limited to a few large companies.



Recycling & Waste Management

Global : South Korea and Germany have advanced waste collection and EPR systems.

India : Weak collection and recycling infrastructure limit circularity.



Supply Chain & Logistics Integration

Global : China and Singapore operate highly integrated packaging and logistics ecosystems.

India : Fragmented logistics increase costs and inefficiencies.



Smart Manufacturing & Automation

Global : Japan and Germany use AI, robotics, and automation to improve efficiency and reduce defects.

India : Automation adoption remains low among MSMEs.

Source: [imarcgroup](#)

New & Innovative Packaging Ideas for Indian Manufacturing

Innovation	Overview	Conventional Alternative	Industry Example
Sugarcane Bagasse	Packaging made from leftover sugarcane pulp	Plastic trays, plates & food containers	Ecoware, Chuk (used by Starbucks, PVR, DMRC)
Mycelium (Mushroom) Packaging	Grown from mushroom roots & farm waste	EPS foam & thermocol packaging	Roha Biotech (IIT Madras)
Palm Leaf & Bamboo Tableware	Disposable tableware made from naturally fallen palm leaves and bamboo.	Plastic & thermocol cutlery	EcoSoul Home (India; also exports to US/Europe)
Cornstarch Bioplastic	Compostable bioplastic produced from renewable corn starch.	Plastic films, bags & cutlery	BioPak India
Seaweed Film	Plastic-free biodegradable film made from seaweed.	Plastic pouches & wraps	Go Do Good

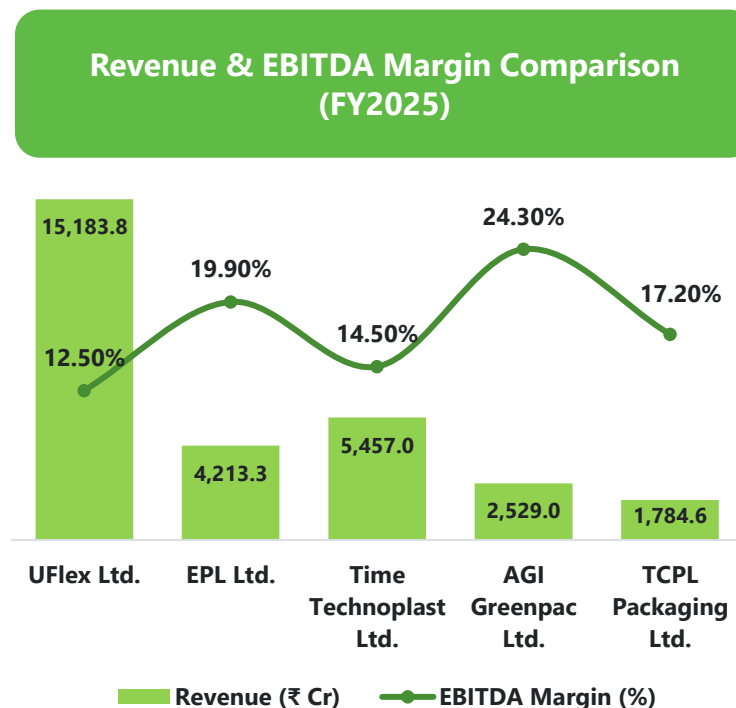
Source: pakka.com, thegreenista, biopatrika, changestarted

Competitive Landscape

Evaluating the financial performance and strategic positioning of India's leading packaging companies.

Financial Comparison of Leading Indian Packaging Companies

Company	Core Segment	Revenue (₹ Cr)	EBITDA (₹ Cr)	EBITDA Margin	Net Profit (₹ Cr)	Market Cap (₹ Cr)
UFlex Ltd.	Flexible Packaging	15,183.8	1,902.4	12.5%	320.1	3,110
EPL Ltd.	Specialty Tubes	4,213.3	836.0	19.9%	359.0	7,237
Time Technoplast Ltd.	Industrial Packaging	5,457.0	790.2	14.5%	394.4	8,885
AGI Greenpac Ltd.	Rigid / Glass Packaging	2,529.0	614.0	24.3%	322.0	4,051
TCPL Packaging Ltd.	Rigid & Flexible (Cartons)	1,784.6	307.4	17.2%	143.0	2,577



Although UFlex generates the highest revenue, AGI Greenpac and EPL achieve higher EBITDA margins by focusing on higher-value packaging segments such as glass containers and laminated tubes.

Source: [uflexltd](#), [eplglobal](#), [screener](#), [time-technoplast](#), [AGI](#), [bseindia](#)

Decoding Financial Health: Ratio-by-Ratio

Company	P/E Ratio (x)	ROE (%)	ROCE (%)	Debt-to-Equity (x)
UFlex Ltd.	9.3	4.3%	7.0%	1.13
EPL Ltd.	18.4	15.8%	17.8%	0.29
Time Technoplast	23.0	13.4%	15.1%	0.19
AGI Greenpac Ltd	11.4	15.8%	19.6%	0.26
TCPL Packaging	22.8	24.0%	19.7%	0.85

- TCPL Packaging and AGI Greenpac demonstrate the strongest financial performance, supported by industry-leading ROCE and ROE.
- UFlex trails the peer set on profitability and leverage, recording the lowest ROE and ROCE at 4.3% and 7.0%, respectively, alongside the highest debt-to-equity ratio of 1.13x.

Source: [uflexltd](#), [epglobal](#), [screener](#), [time-technoplast](#), [AGI](#), [bseindia](#)

Competitive Positioning Matrix

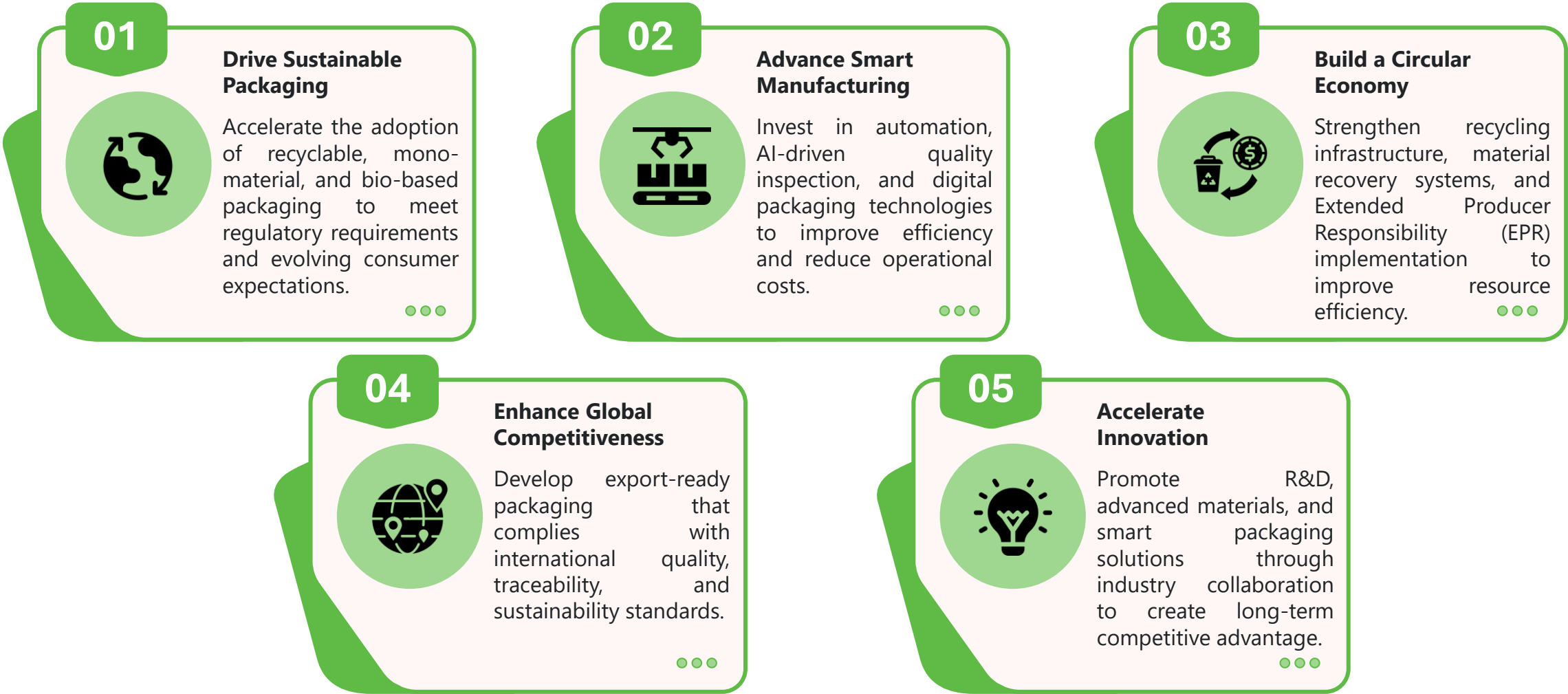
Comparison Criteria	UFlex	EPL	Time Technoplast	AGI Greenpac	TCPL Packaging
Core Packaging Segment	Flexible Packaging (Films & Laminates)	Specialty Packaging (Laminated Tubes)	Industrial Packaging (Drums & IBCs)	Rigid Packaging (Glass & PET)	Rigid & Flexible (Cartons)
Key End-use Industries	FMCG, Food, Pharma	Oral Care, Beauty, Pharma	Chemicals, Petrochemicals, Energy	Alco-Bev, Pharma, Food	Tobacco, FMCG, Liquor
Manufacturing Presence	India & 8 countries	India & 9 countries	India & 10 countries	India (7 plants)	India (9 plants) & UAE
Export Presence	Strong, 150+ countries	Strong, global tube leader	Moderate, ~35% of revenue	Moderate, 25+ countries	Limited, expanding to the US
Competitive Strength	Largest integrated flexible packaging player	~37% share in oral-care tubes	World's largest plastic drum maker	2nd-largest organized glass packaging player	India's largest folding carton maker
Key Customers	P&G, PepsiCo, Nestle, ITC	Colgate-Palmolive, HUL	IOCL & petrochemical majors	500+ institutional clients	Unilever, Nestle, Godrej

Source: [uflexltd](#), [epglobal](#), [screener](#), [time-technoplast](#), [AGI](#), [bseindia](#)

MARC Outlook

Our perspective on the strategic initiatives that will shape the next phase of growth in India's packaging industry.

MARC Perspective: Where the Industry Should Focus





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